

Course Grading Guidelines

Václav Petrák

February 20, 2026

Classification and Grading

There is no exam. Your grade will be based on your independent work. There are three outputs used for grading.

1. **Journal Club Presentation:** 20% of the final grade
2. **Capstone Project Written Report:** 50% of the final grade
3. **Poster Presentation:** 30% of the final grade

1 Journal Club

A journal club is a group who meet to critically evaluate articles in the academic literature. Journal clubs:

- Encourages critical thinking.
- Helps in understanding the studied concepts and methods.
- Helps keep up with the latest research.
- Improves communication and presentation skills.
- Presentation simulates experience of a scientist.

The main purpose in this course is to explore how methods we learned are applied in current research.

1.1 Your Task for Journal Club

- You will read a research paper related to the topic of your capstone project.
- Your task is to read the paper and prepare a 15-minute presentation, followed by a 5-minute discussion, to explain the paper.
- The presentation dates will be arranged individually.

1.2 Journal Club Presentation Content

The Journal Club presentation will cover:

- **Introduction:** Provide a High-level Overview on the background of the research topic and the main objectives of the paper.
- **Methods:** Give overview of the methodology used in the paper.
- **Results:** Highlight the key results and conclusions of the paper.
- **Discussion:** Discuss the practical implications of the research and its applications in real-world situations. Discuss any limitations of the paper.

- **Conclusions:** Summarize the main contributions and overall findings of **the paper**. Reiterate its key takeaways and their broader implications.
- **Q&A:** Answer questions from the audience (lecturer).

1.3 Grading Criteria for Journal Club Presentation

Presentation Design and Delivery (50%)

- **Design:** The presentation is well-organized and easy to follow.
- **Timing:** The presenter adhered to the 15-minute presentation format.
- **Delivery:** Clear and confident speech with appropriate pacing.
- **Questions:** Convincing response to questions.

Content of the presentation (50%)

- **Introduction:** The introduction provides a high-level overview of the topic: explains the research motivation and the research question.
- **Methods:** Explains the experimental approach used by the authors. Unfamiliar methods are explained without going into excessive detail.
- **Results:** The key results from the paper are explained.
- **Critical evaluation:** For example critique of methods, ideas for improvement, significance of the results.

2 Capstone Project

The Capstone project is your independent project.

- You will work on an independent project that builds on and further extends course content.
- Output of your work will be a written report (formatted as an academic article), a poster, and code.

2.1 Capstone Project Report Content

The Capstone Project written report will cover:

- **Introduction:** Provide a High-level Overview on the background of the research topic and the main objectives of **your project**.
- **Methods:** Give overview of the methodology used in **your project**.
- **Results:** Highlight the key results and conclusions of **your project**.
- **Discussion:** Discuss the practical implications of **your project's findings** and their applications in real-world situations. Discuss any limitations of **your project**.
- **Conclusions:** Summarize the main contributions and overall findings of **your project**. Reiterate its key takeaways and their broader implications.

2.2 Grading Criteria for Capstone Project

Report Quality and Structure (50%)

- **Formatting:** The report is well-organized, logically structured, and follows the conventions of a scientific article.
- **Writing Clarity:** The text is clear, professional, and effectively communicates complex concepts.
- **Plots and Figures:** Clear graphical presentation of simulation results that address project objectives and show model behavior. All figures are properly labeled and referenced in the text.

Model Implementation and Analysis (50%)

- **Correctness:** Correct function of fundamental models.
- **Understanding:** Demonstrated understanding of core concepts as articulated in the report.
- **Extension beyond core:** Successful and meaningful implementation of additional features (if the task specifies them).
- **Discussion:** Insightful written analysis on how parameters/initial conditions affect outcomes. Identification and thorough explanation of behaviors.

3 Poster Presentation

A poster presentation is a visual communication tool commonly used at academic conferences. It combines text and graphics to present your project in a way that is visually accessible and encourages one-on-one discussion. Poster sessions:

- Develop skills in synthesizing complex information into a concise visual format.
- Improve the ability to engage in interactive, informal professional discussions.
- Simulate real-world networking and conference experiences.

3.1 Your Task for the Poster

- You will design a scientific poster based on your Capstone Project.
- You should be prepared to give a short (e.g., 3-minute) "elevator pitch" summarizing your work to the audience.
- You will stand by your poster to answer questions and discuss your findings in an informal setting.

3.2 Poster Content and Layout

A successful poster should be visually engaging and easy to read from a distance. It typically includes:

- **Header:** Title, author(s), and affiliations.
- **Introduction/Objectives:** Briefly state the problem, motivation, and the goals of your project.
- **Methods:** Visual overview of your approach (flowcharts or diagrams are highly encouraged).
- **Results:** Key findings presented primarily through clear, well-labeled plots, figures, or tables. Keep text to a minimum.
- **Conclusions:** Bullet points summarizing the main takeaways and future directions.

3.3 Grading Criteria for Poster Presentation

Visual Design and Layout (50%)

- **Readability:** Text is legible from a distance; clear font choices and appropriate sizing.
- **Visuals:** Effective use of charts, graphs, and diagrams instead of dense blocks of text.
- **Organization:** Logical flow of information that guides the reader's eye naturally from introduction to conclusion.

Content and Interactive Discussion (50%)

- **Clarity of Message:** The core objective and main findings are immediately clear.
- **Elevator Pitch:** Ability to concisely summarize the poster in a few minutes without simply reading directly from it.
- **Q&A Engagement:** Confident, accurate, and engaging responses to questions posed during the poster session.